

	2024-01421781	
12	Watson v. Notarize, Inc. 2023-01310277	<u>Plaintiff's Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class Action and PAGA Settlement</u> The court has reviewed and considered the papers, including the supplemental papers, filed in support of plaintiff's motion for preliminary approval of a \$182,500 class action and PAGA settlement. Subject to plaintiff's submission of the documents (including the revised notice) discussed below, the court grants the motion as follows: \$10,000.00 for plaintiff's enhancement payment (not to exceed); \$60,833.33 for attorneys' fees (not to exceed to 1/3 of gross settlement amount); \$15,000.00 for litigation costs (not to exceed); \$5,000.00 for settlement administration costs (not to exceed); and \$20,000.00 total PAGA penalties (\$15,00.00 to LWDA). The court has the following comments: 1. In its July 23, 2024 order (ROA 75), the court instructed the parties to remove the word "strongly" from the past paragraph on page 3 of the notice. 7/23/24 Order (ROA 75) ¶ 17; see also 12/5/24 Order (ROA 87) ¶ 8. The parties appear to have removed the word "strongly" from a different part of the notice, not from the last paragraph on page 3 of the notice. Plaintiff is ordered to file and serve by <u>April 24, 2025</u> a copy of the proposed order with all exhibits attached, including a copy of the settlement agreement, any amendments thereto, and a revised notice (as discussed above). Only one copy of the notice should be attached as an exhibit to the proposed order; duplicate copies should not be attached. The final approval hearing is scheduled for <u>September 11, 2025 at 2:00 p.m.</u> in Department CX104. The motion for final approval shall be filed at least 16 court days before the hearing. See Department CX104 Guidelines for Approval of Class Action Settlements and PAGA Settlements (www.occourts.org). Plaintiffs are ordered to give notice, including to the LWDA, and to file a proof of service.